ECCO — Meeting Prep & Stocking Decision

Prepared 2026-06-15. Meeting: tomorrow.

The question

Should I be worried that Amazon sells ECCO's main products themselves, and not order? And/or should I undercut on Shopify to win volume? (ECCO Soft 7 Women's is at £80 on Amazon.)

Two facts that reframe it

1. **The Soft 7 is a mature, heavily-discounted core model.** There are ~77 live UK offers from **£56** — Amazon's £80 isn't a sharp price to "undercut," it's mid-pack. The whole market already sells this shoe cheap.
2. **ECCO sells only through authorised retailers** and voids warranty on unauthorised sales — so they actively manage their channel and pricing.

Update — ECCO's pricing stance (confirmed by ECCO)

ECCO's own words when asked about selling on Amazon/marketplaces:

> *"Yes that's fine Andreas, we like to work with retailers that support the brand and its pricing, and actively look to move away from retailers that discount continuity stock heavily I would say that. But all marketplaces are fine to sell on."*

What this means — three things, all the right ones:

- **"support the brand and its pricing"** — they want retailers who *hold* price.
- **"move away from retailers that discount continuity stock heavily"** — they police it and cut offenders. Keyword: **continuity stock** = core, year-round models (the Soft 7 *is* continuity). That's the stock they want held.
- **"all marketplaces are fine"** — no channel restriction; the only string attached is pricing.

This is the **price discipline our engine needs**, and our model (hold price, win on fulfilment/reviews/availability) is exactly the retailer profile ECCO rewards — not the one it purges. We're aligned, not in conflict.

Does ECCO fit our business model? (the real question)

Our model is a **fulfilment engine for top styles**: customer searches a known style → compares price + reviews + availability → buys from us. This works on Birkenstock not just because they're hero styles, but because Birk enforces **near-flat pricing**. Price gets neutralised, so the decision falls onto what we're good at — in-stock size tail, reviews, trust, fast fulfilment.

	Price disciplined (flat market)	Price fragmented (race to floor)
Searched / hero demand	✓ Birkenstock Arizona — our sweet spot. Win on fulfilment.	! ECCO Soft 7 *today* — high comparison intent + no floor = forced to be cheapest = margin death.
Discovery / curation	Curation play (not our engine)	Bargain-bin (avoid)

ECCO's stated policy aims to move continuity stock **out of the bad box and into the good box** (where Birk lives). If real, the Soft 7 becomes harvestable like the Arizona.

The catch we must verify — enforcement gap

The market *today* still shows the Soft 7 at **£56 across ~77 offers** — on the very "continuity stock" they say they protect. Policy vs reality gap. Two possibilities:

1. **Enforcement is real and tightening** → those £56 sellers are the ones being cut; the market firms up; we list at the held price and convert on fulfilment/reviews. ✓
2. **Enforcement is loose/aspirational** → £56 persists; we list at the held price, lose the comparison, and aren't allowed to discount to compete → stuck unable to convert. ✗

The whole bet rests on which is true. The meeting job is to **pressure-test the enforcement**, not just accept the policy statement.

Direct answers

Worried / don't order? No — but don't build the relationship around hero SKUs like the Soft 7. The real threat isn't "Amazon exists," it's that Amazon + many others have already commoditised the famous models. That's a margin problem, not a reason to walk away.

Undercut on Shopify for volume? No. It's the trap:

- **Can't out-price the manufacturer.** ECCO controls cost; we don't. On a SKU with a £56 floor, any "won" volume is near-zero margin against someone who can always go lower.
- **It can get us cut off.** Premium footwear brands police advertised pricing. Visibly undercutting their own/authorised channel is how you lose stockist status. Confirm their policy before assuming we can discount.
- **Trains the wrong customer.** Our shoppers arrive via Google Shopping, brand search, and email — not real-time Amazon price-matching. Discounting just donates margin.

Our edge is **range + curation + service**, not price. ECCO slots into our existing "comfort footwear specialist" position. Compete where Amazon-direct is weak: long-tail sizes/colours, fit advice, bundling, repeat/email.

What to actually do on ordering — be selective

- **Avoid hero/legacy models for price-led volume** (Soft 7, etc.) — commoditised. Carry a couple for credibility, priced *at* market, not below.
- **Hunt the gaps Amazon/1P doesn't cover well:** newer-season styles, less-common colourways, and the size tail. Brand-direct typically stocks core black/white in core sizes — that's where margin dies.
- **Order small and test first.** Prove sell-through on a curated edit before scaling.

Questions to nail in the meeting

1. **Pricing policy** — Do you operate a MAP/MRP? What's the floor on key lines? How do you handle channel conflict when your own Amazon/.com price undercuts stockists?
2. **Margin** — cost vs RRP per model. Walk if the margin after the *real* selling price (not RRP) doesn't work.
3. **Where are the gaps** — which models/colourways are NOT on ECCO's own Amazon/1P listings? That's the shortlist.
4. **Terms** — minimum order, sale-or-return / returns, marketing co-op, opening-order incentives.
5. **Newness / exclusivity** — early access to new seasonal styles before they commoditise.

What to physically check while on-site

1. **Held/MAP price in writing** — the actual floor per style we'd carry, plus **cost prices** (so we can do margin on the spot).
2. **Make them explain the £56 Soft 7 market.** "Your policy says protect continuity stock — why is it at £56 across 77 sellers right now?" Their answer is the single most revealing thing here. "Those are exactly who we're cutting, here's who we removed recently" = real. Hand-waving = loose.
3. **When did you last actually cut a discounter?** Concrete, recent example. Teeth vs paper.
4. **Get the continuity list** — which styles are continuity (price-protected → our engine candidates) vs seasonal/end-of-line (will be discounted → avoid for our model).
5. **Inspect build / fit / quality** of the styles we'd list — we sell on reviews and low returns; check what we'd stand behind.
6. **Size depth + replenishment** — full size run availability and restock speed. Our engine lives on the in-stock size tail; continuity stock should mean reliable replenishment. Confirm it.

Bottom line

ECCO's pricing stance is genuinely good news — it's the price discipline that makes our fulfilment engine viable on ECCO, and we're the kind of retailer they want. The deal is a **"yes" if** we can satisfy ourselves the enforcement is real (the £56 question is the test). If the current £56 reality can't be explained, treat it as a red flag — not an automatic dealbreaker — and don't over-commit the opening order until the channel firms up. Order the continuity lines where margin works; hold price; win on fulfilment.

Sources

- ECCO Soft 7 Women price comparison — idealo UK: idealo.co.uk
- ECCO Soft 7 W — official ECCO GB: gb.ecco.com
- ECCO customer service (authorised retailers / warranty): us.ecco.com